

Bridging AI Gaps for Transportation Agencies: ITSJPO AI Program & Products

RIDOT AI Symposium & Peer Exchange

August 19-20, 2026



Image Source: ITS JPO



U.S. Department of Transportation
ITS Joint Program Office

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AI Governance: “The Foundation”

Three Areas of Focus



The diagram consists of three colored squares arranged horizontally. The first square on the left is light blue and contains the word 'Structures'. The middle square is light green and contains the text 'Policies & Processes'. The third square on the right is light orange and contains the word 'Workforce'. All three squares have a thin dark blue border.

Structures

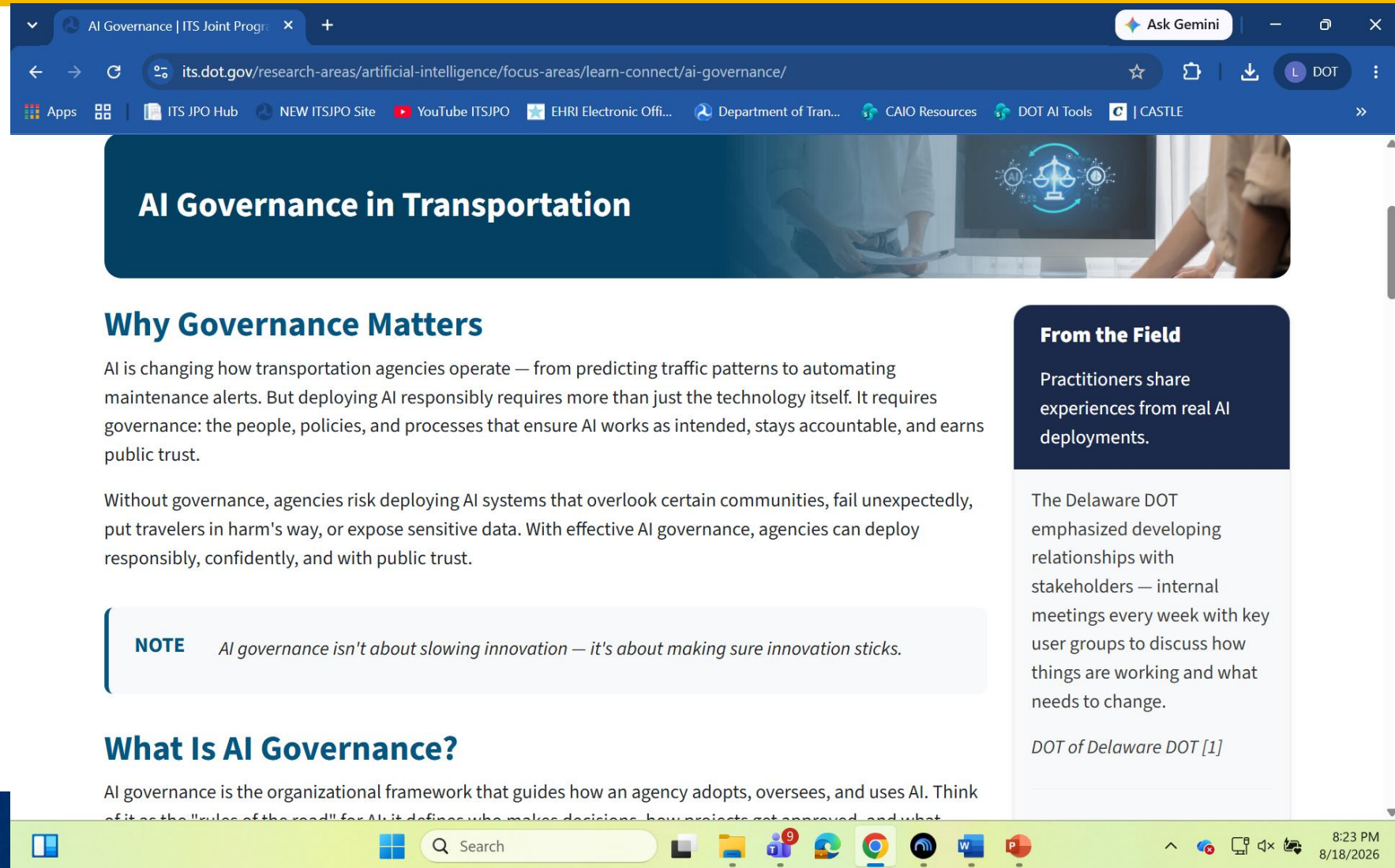
**Policies &
Processes**

Workforce

AI Insights: AI Governance in Transportation

Part of ITS JPO AI Insights Series

- Why
- What
- How
- Who
- Peer Examples



The screenshot shows a web browser displaying the ITS JPO AI Governance page. The browser's address bar shows the URL its.dot.gov/research-areas/artificial-intelligence/focus-areas/learn-connect/ai-governance/. The page has a blue header with the title "AI Governance in Transportation" and a background image of people working at a computer. The main content area is divided into sections: "Why Governance Matters", "What Is AI Governance?", and "From the Field". The "Why Governance Matters" section explains that AI is changing transportation operations and that governance is needed to ensure AI works as intended, stays accountable, and earns public trust. The "What Is AI Governance?" section defines it as the organizational framework that guides how an agency adopts, oversees, and uses AI. The "From the Field" section features a quote from the Delaware DOT about developing relationships with stakeholders. A "NOTE" box states that AI governance is about making sure innovation sticks, not slowing it down. The browser's taskbar at the bottom shows various application icons and the system clock indicating 8:23 PM on 8/18/2026.

AI Governance | ITS Joint Program Office

its.dot.gov/research-areas/artificial-intelligence/focus-areas/learn-connect/ai-governance/

Apps | ITS JPO Hub | NEW ITSJPO Site | YouTube ITSJPO | EHRI Electronic Offi... | Department of Tran... | CAIO Resources | DOT AI Tools | CASTLE

AI Governance in Transportation

Why Governance Matters

AI is changing how transportation agencies operate — from predicting traffic patterns to automating maintenance alerts. But deploying AI responsibly requires more than just the technology itself. It requires governance: the people, policies, and processes that ensure AI works as intended, stays accountable, and earns public trust.

Without governance, agencies risk deploying AI systems that overlook certain communities, fail unexpectedly, put travelers in harm's way, or expose sensitive data. With effective AI governance, agencies can deploy responsibly, confidently, and with public trust.

NOTE *AI governance isn't about slowing innovation — it's about making sure innovation sticks.*

What Is AI Governance?

AI governance is the organizational framework that guides how an agency adopts, oversees, and uses AI. Think of it as the "rules of the road" for AI: it defines who makes decisions, how projects get approved, and what

From the Field

Practitioners share experiences from real AI deployments.

The Delaware DOT emphasized developing relationships with stakeholders — internal meetings every week with key user groups to discuss how things are working and what needs to change.

DOT of Delaware DOT [1]

ITS JPO's Artificial Intelligence (AI) Program

Collaboratively lead the development, deployment, and adoption of safe, secure, and trustworthy AI technology solutions in transportation.



Development

Develop enabling tools and resources to advance multimodal AI implementation.

- **AI Risk Management**
 - Testing, Evaluation, Validation & Verification & Standards
- AI and Data
- AI Procurement
 - **Sept 17th National Webinar**
- **AI Governance**



Deployment

Deploy AI-enabled systems, tools, and applications for multimodal uses.

- AI Pilot Deployments NOFO
- AI SBIR Projects
- Special Research Projects
- AI Use Case Identification, Prioritization & Prototyping (IP3)



Drive Adoption

Drive public-sector adoption of secure, safe, and trustworthy AI.

- AI Capability Maturity Model (CMM)
 - Implementation Guide, Quick Start Primer, Tool, Workshops
- AI Case Studies Series
- AI Knowledge Transfer Strategies (AI cohorts, webinars/ peer exchanges)



AI CMM (The “Compass”): What to Use?

CMM Resources

- Executive primer
- Implementation guide
- Online Tool
- Workshops and webinars (action plan oriented)



Image Source: Gemini

Assessment Categories

- Leadership & Governance
- Processes
- People
- Partnering
- Data
- AI Development
- AI Deployment
- Risk & Security

National Webinar: Demystifying AI Procurement

National Webinar

- **Goal:** Build knowledge & awareness of key AI considerations during procurement lifecycle phases for multimodal agencies
- **September 17th 1-4pm eastern**
- Open to staff and leadership from transportation agencies
- *Save the Date* & registration information coming out soon

Event Objectives

- Demonstrate cross-agency roles and responsibilities in AI procurement for transportation
- Equip multimodal transportation agencies with actionable information to identify and mitigate AI-specific procurement risks
- Assess effective multimodal AI procurement practices and examples

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AI Governance: Risk Management & Trustworthiness

RIDOT AI Symposium Session: -
Governance Frameworks for
Successful AI Implementation

August 19, 2026



Image Source: ITS-JPO

Enterprise AI Governance: “The Foundation”

Definition

Overarching framework that defines agency structures, roles, policies, critical decision phases to ensure that AI is adopted safely, legally, transparently, and strategically across an agency.

Core Components

- **Executive Leadership & Oversight:** Defined agency structures, forums, and roles to govern AI prioritization, development, deployment, and sustained maintenance.
- **Operational Policies:** Clear guidelines establishing acceptable AI use, data privacy, system transparency, and critical procurement considerations.
- **Lifecycle Risk Assurance:** Embedded risk guardrails through testing and evaluation checkpoints integrated across all project lifecycle phases.
- **Asset & Data Governance:** Standardized management of data ownership, model inventories, system documentation, and intellectual property (IP) rights.

Safe & Trustworthy AI: The “Guardrails”

- **Risk Assurance & Management:** Identifying and mitigating AI specific vulnerabilities
 - **TEVV (Test, Evaluation, Verification, & Validation):** Developing and using “guardrail” processes to support AI systems that are safe, trustworthy & reliable before, during, and after deployment.
 - **Standards & Evaluation:** Defining and applying consistent benchmarks

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Safe & Trustworthy AI: The “Guardrails”



Image Source: NotebookLM

Safe & Trustworthy AI: TEVV Protocols



COMPREHENSIVE TEVV PROCESSES

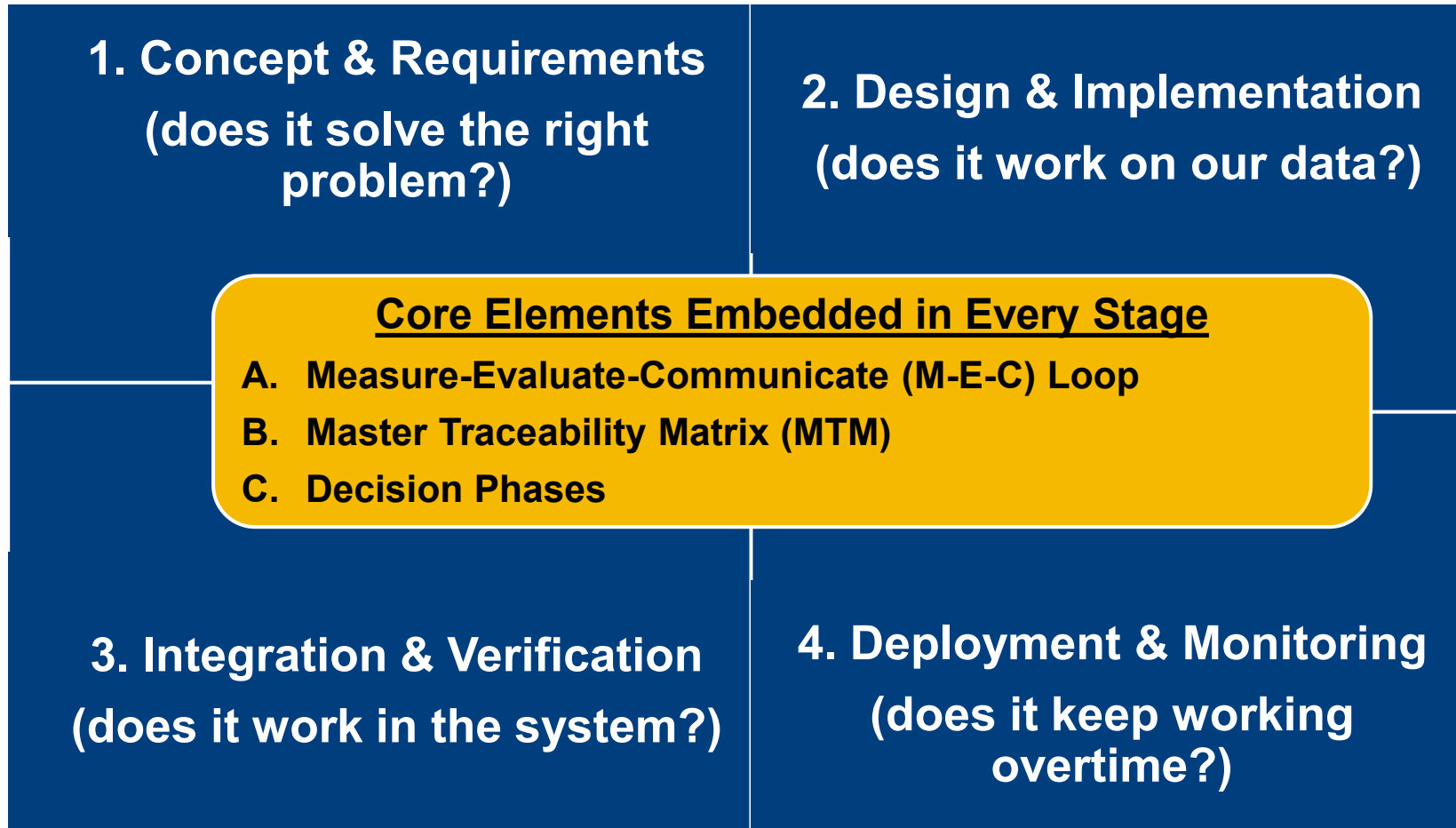
checkpoints, metrics, and actions

to maintain

safe, secure & trustworthy AI systems

- Basis for **establishing confidence** in AI systems
- **Aligns with enterprise** risk management approaches
- **Customizable**
- Based on **NIST AI Risk Framework**

AI TEVV: Lifecycle Stages & Resources



Resources

- Executive AI Risk Primer (*coming soon*)
- AI TEVV Technical Playbook
- AI Technical Resources
 - Sample Risk plan & catalog
 - Sample TEVV plan
 - Sample Traceability matrix
 - Sample Metrics catalog
 - Sample Tools catalog
 - Sample Data plan

AI TEVV: Summary Implementation Steps

- **Tailor Agency Foundation:** Adapt sample risk catalogs to specific project context
- **Quantify Possible Risks & Impacts:** Identify AI-specific risks to generate a standardized risk score
- **Conduct Strategic Prioritization:** Focus resources on high-impact risks
- **Prepare Proactive Mitigation:** Establish clear strategies to counteract possible risks.
- **Define Success:** Develop set of performance metrics to evaluate AI system.

AI Governance & Risk: Procurement Focus

- **Governance & Procurement Foundation:** Enterprise AI governance sets the clear safety rules, leadership authority, and technical standards that guide all agency AI projects and procurements.
- **Procurement Enforces the Rules:** Procurement turns high-level governance policies, data privacy standards, and safety testing requirements into enforceable vendor contracts.
- **Tailored to How AI is Built:** Customizes oversight approach based on AI development approach: 1) in-house development; 2) joint development; and 3) vendor procured



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